Brainstorming the structure of a grammar module

PROMPT

I teach English at university and I create online courses on Genially and Moodle.

In the Genially part, my courses are organised as follows:

0) An overall scenario for the whole course, related to the concerns of young adults, fun but realistic.

1) INTRODUCTION: an exercise in which students observe a corpus showing all the types of usage I will then explain, and organise them into sections after a conceptualisation question.

2) HUB: a menu with the different sections I will then develop, either in a linear order or with students choosing what they will study first, depending on the type of course.

3) SECTION 1:

a) An introductory observation exercise with all the terms that will be covered, followed by conceptualisation using, for example, a drag-and-drop table with columns, or a quiz, whichever is most appropriate. It is introduced by a first part of the scenario (be careful: it must remain coherent if the order after the hub is not linear; if it is linear, the story moves forward).

b) Explanation of the rules, making sure students are active: at the very least with click-and-reveal, but if there are ways of making them truly active, those should be preferred.

c) An exercise checking understanding of the rule, called “Vous suivez” (“Are you following?”). There may be one or two exercises depending on relevance and length. There is feedback for a correct answer, with a short confirmation of the answer and, where relevant, further explanation, and short, CONCISE, clear, non-threatening formative feedback explaining an incorrect answer. The feedback must be consistent with the course. Format: I use all of Genially’s native exercise types as appropriate (drag and drop, multiple-answer MCQ, single-answer MCQ, ranking…), but for gap-fills I can only include one gap.

4) SECTION 2 onwards:

Same structure as section 1.

5) Final concluding page: a concluding corpus with a slightly fun ending, and a recap exercise to check that the whole course has been understood. The scenario is complete, but may continue in section 6.

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6) Between 5 and 10 interactive exercises using Genially formats, on Genially, to test mastery of the notions explained. This is a spin-off of the scenario, but do not repeat exactly the same words or the same quizzes as in the previous “Vous suivez” exercises. There is short feedback for a correct answer, with a short confirmation of the answer and possibly further explanation, and CONCISE, clear, non-threatening formative feedback explaining an incorrect answer. The feedback must be consistent with the course. Format: I use all of Genially’s native exercise types as appropriate (drag and drop, multiple-answer MCQ, single-answer MCQ, ranking…), but for gap-fills I can only include one gap.

7) Graded assessment on Moodle: a new scenario with a wide range of everyday situations. Any question type from the native Quiz plugin can be used: choose the most relevant one for each notion. There is feedback for a correct answer, with confirmation of the answer and further explanation, and non-threatening formative feedback explaining an incorrect answer. The feedback must be consistent with the course, but the further explanation in the feedback for a correct answer can go further (B2).

Course level: B1+ (students who are supposed to have covered the B2 notions but are in fact B1, often struggling, and need to reach B2 level).

You must focus on the mistakes French speakers often make in English.

Language:

- The overall scenario is in English, but a translation is provided.
- The scenarios introducing the units are in French, but the corpora students work on to deduce the rules are in English.
- The mini-scenarios of the exercises and the instructions are in English.
- The explanations of the rules and the feedback are in French.
- All examples are in English and, if they are difficult for a French speaker to understand, a translation is given.

Example: see the course “Le fil d’Ariane”.

I have a first proposal for the content, but you can reorganise it, improve it and turn it into a scenario. Here it is (see Word + PDF).

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